28 December 2025 — קדושה דסידרא, ובא לציון, and שיר של יום

Independent review · read fresh, from the finished HTML only (as delivered, before part-3 corrections) · 1 November 2026

1.Overall Read

A thirteen-section write-up (roughly 3,700 words of body plus a twenty-five-note *Mareh Mekomos* apparatus of about 1,700 words) on the end of *Shacharis*: *Lamnatzeach* and its midrash (I–III), *parnassah* and the vessel (IV–VI), *Kedushah DeSidra* from Sotah (VII–VIII), the decree against *Kedushah* (IX), the latecomers (XI), and *Shir Shel Yom* (XII–XIII). The spine is clear and the movement from Sotah, through Rashi, to the decree is the strongest stretch. The hard editorial issues are six: (a) a Hebrew date and a "today is Ezra's *yahrtzeit*" that do not match "this week's *parashah*" or a Sunday in Tevet; (b) a verse quoted in the wrong order; (c) the voice of oral delivery throughout; (d) section IX, which carries four topics under one heading; (e) footnotes with working notes and citations that do not exist; and (f) a sentence that does not parse in section VI and the Zohar in XIII.

2.What Works

- **The labor *midrash* (II–III).** "How did you arrive in the world?" is a real insight, set up with the doctor's "breathe in, breathe out," and applied cleanly to the close of davening.
- **Sotah to Rashi to the original learning (VII).** Three sub-headings, each short; the question ("how can the world continue?") and the answer are both stated. The best structural passage.

- **The guards who leave after *Sim Shalom* (IX).** A vivid, specific mechanism ("precisely the moment *Kedushah* would normally be recited"), and the explanation of the Targum follows from it.
- **The latecomers (XI).** "Instead of dismissing them, *Chazal* established an entirely new mini-*tefillah* for them" is the right pitch.
- **The three-year-old (XIII).** A short, human anchor for the Ramban's count of the days.
- **Footnote hygiene.** Twenty-five notes in body order with back-links; the short/expanded format is consistent and Hebrew is inline throughout.

3.Where It's Weak or Could Be Sharper

The date. The meta line reads "28 · כ״ח טבת תשפ״ו · 28 December 2025." 28 Tevet 5786 is in January 2026; by calculation 28 December 2025 is 8 Tevet (Asara B'Tevet is 30 December). The callout "today — כ״ח טבת — is the *yahrtzeit* of Ezra" repeats the error; even with the day right, it is not clear the traditional date is 28 Tevet. A learned reader will notice, and so will a reader who sees "this week's *parashah*" at VI.

The verse is quoted backwards. In VII and again in fn 10: בערב תאמר מי יתן ובבקר תאמר מי יתן ערב. The verse in the rebuke is the other way around; the explanation that follows ("at night … longs for morning") works either way, which hides the error.

The voice. The text moves between a sefer voice and the voice of the speaker: "with all this, bagels and lox," "My little three-year-old," "My grandfather הרב זצ״ל בעלסקי ישראל once told me" (which grandfather?), "This is at least the sixth or seventh time on this journey through תפילה," "Once I gave an entire שיעור Boys," "Reb Yehuda Honein was kind enough to send me." For a printed edition these need a speaker label ("the Rav," as the Sefer Edition does) or removal.

Section IX is overloaded. Its heading is “The Most Astonishing Reason — A Decree Against [illegible]” but under it come a book (the [illegible] הפרדס), a digression on how *Chazal* regarded Yeshu, the history of Christianity inside the synagogues, the decree, the enactment, the Targum, why it remained, and a callout on the Musaf *Shema*. The digression (“Once I gave an entire [illegible] שיעור”) and the claim that the origins of Christianity “were inside our own [illegible] בתי כנסיות” carry a historical weight that the notes do not support; attribute them to the Pardes or to the Rav, not to the voice of the narrator.

A sentence that does not parse. In VI: “the word ‘(ה-א)’ [illegible] in the [illegible] תורה hints at כנסת אורחים [illegible] and (the [illegible] of) [illegible] ק.” The ellipsis and the “[illegible]” are unexplained. Say that [illegible] is an acronym for כנסת אורחים. Also the [illegible] ספר הקדושים is not a known title; the note itself says “exact title and authorship should be verified” — a working note left in print.

Section XIII: the Zohar and “Not so [illegible] גליון”. The paragraph cites “historical sources and the [illegible] רמ״ה for the names of the days, and fn 25 builds a Zohar mapping to the *sefiros* that the paragraph does not use. Also “These are all gods. Not so [illegible] גלי״ן” is a garbled Yiddish exclamation. And “At [illegible] ערבית we add [illegible] ותסו נרננה [illegible] עי״בצ” sits oddly in a paragraph on the song of the day, and is wrong (it is added at the end of the day’s song).

Section V (the empty carriage). “The first chassid had brought an *empty* carriage” is told in the narrator’s voice, with no source, in the manner of a *Chassidishe* tale; the earlier story (the Alshich) has a heading and a moral, this has neither. Attribute it (“a story told by a congregant”) or fold it into the Alshich callout.

4.Factual / Citation Concerns

Fn 1 (Berachos 28b; Megillah 17b). The note says the Gemara	
“derives the eighteen	ברכות. from various … sources, including a

parallel to the eighteen and then cites 9b–10a for the one-unit count. The first citation (28b) is for the other reasons; the 18-chapter reason is the second. Separate them.

Fn 6 (Eichah 1:15). The note attributes to the verse the prohibition of tefillin, of certain study and the absence of Tachanun; the section it supports (IV) is about *Lamnatzeach* only. Overstated.

Fn 7 (Ramban on Shemos 13:16). The verse is cited with no reason connecting it to trust and effort (it is the end of *Bo*). A reader who looks it up will be confused.

Fn 13 (Rambam Tefillah 9:17). "פט״ז הי״ז is an odd form, and the note ends "Verify exact from the printed — a working note. The body states "ברמ״ם paskens accordingly" without a hedge.

Fn 14 (Tur 132; Shulchan Aruch; Mishnah Berurah). Three sources are cited for one sentence; the body says only that “we follow other Rishonim.” The Mishnah Berurah is stated to “codify” the individual’s saying it, with no reference.

Fn 18 (Hilchos Melachim 11:14). “וה״ד is not a halakhah number in the chapter; the “uncensored editions” label suggests the passage is in 11:4. Also “recovered in the Frankel” is a claim about editions not otherwise supported.

Fn 20 (Beis Yosef, OC 496). The body and the note both say the Beis Yosef discusses whether the Yom Tov Sheni rationale still applies. The Gemara in Beitzah 4 is the likelier source; if the Beis Yosef is meant, give the text.

Fn 23 (Arachin 11a). The quoted words “אין אומרים שירה אלא ביום

and the Divrei HaYamim derivation should be given a source or removed.

Fn 16 and Fn 19. “Of Vitry” and “11th–12th century” for the Pardes;

“*Lechem Shamayim*” for the Yaavetz; “Steinsaltz, Oz Vehadar” for the

restored text — all uncited.

5.Small Polish Suggestions

- Unify transliteration: *yid*/*yidden*/*davening*/*shul* sprinkled through; the subtitle and headings mix English and Hebrew in different ways.
- “The קללה חוה carried” (II) is missing a word: “the curse that חוה received.”
- The summary says the Rav says the song of the day has “six other מזמורים;” give the list (fn 22 does).
- The closing section is two sentences; either expand to a two-line summary of the three reasons for ובא לציון or drop the heading.
- The last callout in IX (“A Parallel — שמע ישראל in מוסף קדושה”) has no footnote; fn 20 is about יום טוב שני. Give it its own.
- “Reb Yehuda Honein was kind enough to send me this morning” — keep the courtesy in a sefer? If so, say “the Rav was informed.”
- The lead should say what the piece does not reach (the rest of שיר של יום).

6.Bottom Line

> *A readable, well-ordered write-up whose best passages (the labor midrash, Sotah through Rashi, the guards who leave after Sim Shalom, the latecomers) are real Torah and well placed. It needs one mechanical pass for its firm errors (the date, the reversed verse, the Zohar, the Lechu Neranenah placement, the non-existent halakhah numbers), one structural fix (section IX), and a hedging pass over an apparatus that states more than the shiur does. With those done it can stand as a sefer chapter.*

Produced by an independent editorial pass reading the finished HTML only, without the transcripts. Reviewer brings the perspective of a learned general reader familiar with the standard *siddur*, *Shulchan Aruch Orach Chaim* and the *Gemara* in *Berachos* and *Sotah*.